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GTK and Qt Applications

This guide covers theming applications built with GTK, Qt, and KDE Plasma toolkits.

GTK 3/4 Applications

GTK applications include most GNOME apps and many Linux applications. Noctalia can automatically theme them using the `adw-gtk3` theme.

Setup

1. Install required packages:

```
# Arch Linux / Manjaro
paru -S adw-gtk-theme nwg-look

# Other distributions
# Install adw-gtk-theme and nwg-look from your package manager
```

2. Apply the GTK theme:

- **Using nwg-look (recommended):**

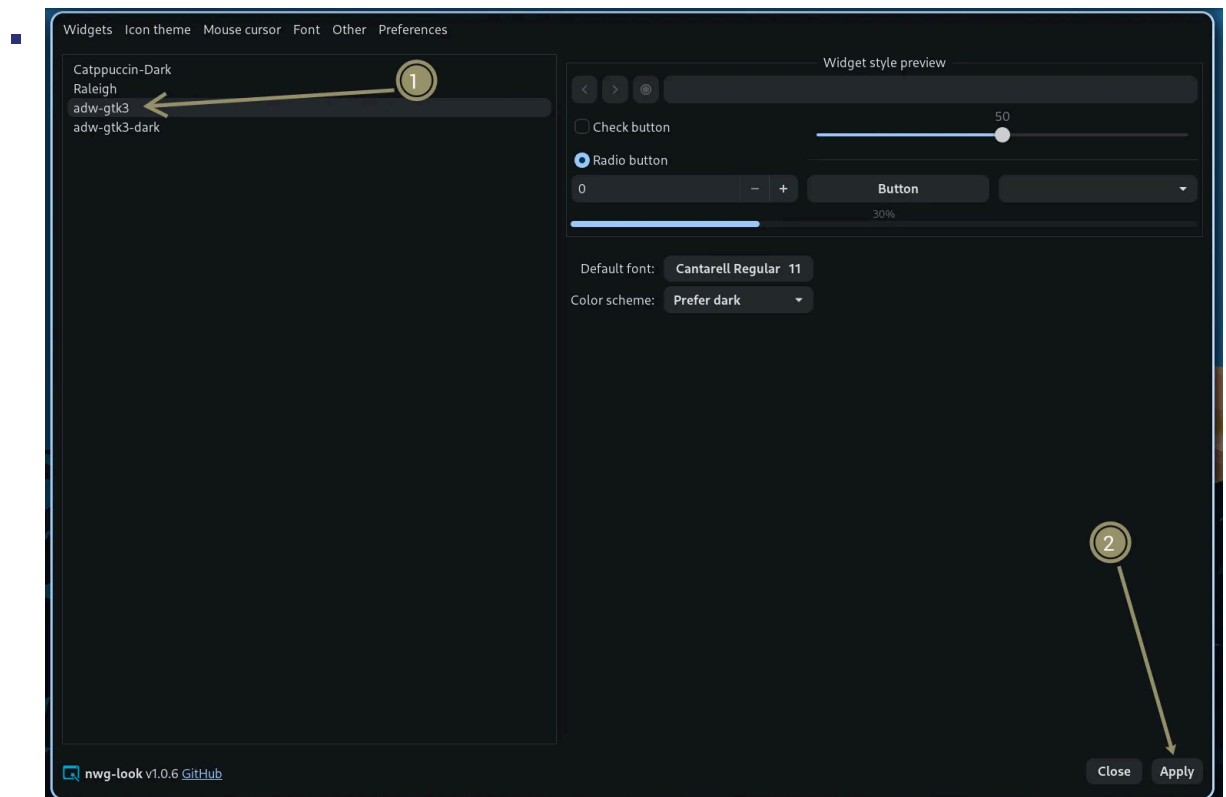
GTK4 Theming

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can prevent GTK applications from using Noctalia's color scheme.

If you previously applied a custom GTK4 theme, you may need to hit **"Clear"** (found in the **Preference** tab) in nwg-look before reapplying and regenerating the color scheme. This ensures the new colors are accepted by GTK4 apps.

- Open nwg-look
- Select adw-gtk3 from the theme list
- Click "Apply"



- Using command line:

```
gsettings set org.gnome.desktop.interface gtk-theme 'adw-gtk3'
```

3. Enable GTK theming in Noctalia:

- Open **Settings → Color Scheme → Templates**

- Toggle on **GTK**

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- **Theme not applying:** Completely restart GTK applications (close and reopen)
- **Some apps still look wrong:** Some GTK apps may need GTK 4 theme separately:

```
gsettings set org.gnome.desktop.interface gtk-theme 'adw-gtk3'  
gsettings set org.gnome.desktop.interface color-scheme 'prefer-dark' # or 'prefer-light'
```

- **Flatpak apps:** Flatpak apps may need the theme installed in their sandbox:

```
flatpak install org.gtk.Gtk3theme.adw-gtk3-dark  
flatpak install org.gtk.Gtk3theme.adw-gtk3
```

Qt Applications

Qt applications include KDE apps and many cross-platform applications. Noctalia themes them through qt6ct.

Setup

1. Install qt6ct:

```
# Arch Linux / Manjaro  
paru -S qt6ct  
  
# Other distributions  
# Install qt6ct from your package manager
```

Better Integration with -kde variants

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or qt5ct.

- **qt6ct-kde:** Patched version of qt6ct for better integration with KDE Qt6 applications.
- **qt5ct-kde:** Patched version of qt5ct for better integration with KDE Qt5 applications. This may also help with theming Chromium-based browsers like **Brave** when they are set to use the Qt theme.

2. **Set environment variable:** Add this to your window manager configuration or shell profile:

For Niri (config.kdl):

```
environment {  
  QT_QPA_PLATFORMTHEME "qt6ct"  
}
```

For Hyprland (hyprland.conf):

```
env = QT_QPA_PLATFORMTHEME,qt6ct
```

For Sway (config):

```
setenv QT_QPA_PLATFORMTHEME qt6ct
```

For shell profile (~/.bashrc or ~/.zshrc):

```
export QT_QPA_PLATFORMTHEME=qt6ct
```

3. **Enable Qt theming in Noctalia:**

- Open **Settings → Color Scheme → Templates**
- Toggle on **Qt**

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- Run qt6ct from terminal
- Go to **Color Scheme** tab
- Select noctalia from the dropdown
- Click **Apply** and **OK**

KDE File Picker

If you use the KDE file picker, go to the **Settings** tab in qt6ct and set **Standard dialogs** to **KDE** (note that this needs plasma-workspace to be installed to appear as a dropdown option)..

Troubleshooting

- **Qt apps not themed:** Ensure the environment variable is set before launching applications
 - **qt6ct not found:** Make sure qt6ct is installed and in your PATH
 - **Theme not updating:** Restart Qt applications after changing color schemes
-

KDE Plasma (KColorScheme)

If you're using KDE Plasma, Noctalia can apply colors through the native KColorScheme system.

Setup

1. Enable KColorScheme in Noctalia:

- Open **Settings → Color Scheme → Templates**
- Toggle on **KColorScheme**

2. Apply in KDE System Settings:

Open System Settings > Appearance > Colors

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- Select the noctalia color scheme
 - The scheme will update automatically when you change colors in Noctalia

Troubleshooting

- **Scheme not appearing:** Restart KDE Plasma or log out and back in
- **Colors not updating:** Ensure KColorScheme toggle is enabled in Noctalia settings